



ORGANISATION INTERNATIONALE
DE MÉTROLOGIE LÉGALE

BUREAU INTERNATIONAL DE MÉTROLOGIE LÉGALE

INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE
OF LEGAL METROLOGY

TWENTY-FIFTH MEETING
Oporto - 3rd to 5th October 1990

MINUTES

CONTENTS

	page
List of persons attending	5
Opening addresses	7
Roll-call of delegates – Quorum	14
Adoption of the agenda	15
Minutes	
1. Approval of the minutes of Twenty-fourth meeting of the Committee	16
2. Member States and Corresponding Members	16
2.1. New accessions – Expected accessions	
2.2. The situation of some Member States	
3. Finance	16
3.1. Approval of the Auditor's report for 1989	
3.2. The financial position in 1990 and 1991	
4. Staff of the Bureau	17
4.1. Replacement of an Assistant Director retiring from the Bureau in May 1991	
4.2. Staff members whose contracts end before end 1992	
4.3. Other business	
5. Certification	18
5.1. Adoption of the document "OIML Certificate System for Measuring Instruments"	
5.2. OIML International Recommendations applicable within the OIML Certificate System	
5.3. Other actions necessary to the effective operation of the System	
6. Working method of OIML Secretariats	24
6.1. Revision of the process for developing International Recommendations and Documents	
6.2. Typical content(s) of Recommendations	
7. Work of the Secretariats	27
7.1. State of progress of work	
7.2. Particular Secretariats	
7.3. Adoption of International Recommendations	
7.4. A method by which the Committee might approve certain revised International Recommendations (R 74 and R 76) at its 26th meeting in 1991	
8. Long-term policy of the Organisation	28
9. Developing countries	29
10. OIML seminars	30
11. Report on the activities of BIML (October 1989-September 1990)	30
12. Other business	30
13. Date and place of the next meeting	30
Decisions and Resolutions	31
Closure	31
Decisions taken by the Committee	33
Annex 1	38
Annex 2	39
Annex 3	41

TWENTY-FIFTH MEETING
of the
INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE of LEGAL METROLOGY
Oporto - 3rd to 5th October 1990

The International Committee of Legal Metrology was convened by its President, Mr K. BIRKELAND, and met in Oporto in the conference room of the hotel Meridien, from Wednesday 3rd to Friday 5th October 1990, on the invitation of the President of the Portuguese Institute for Quality.

LIST OF PERSONS ATTENDING

The following persons were present:

Australia	: J. BIRCH	Member, CIML
Austria	: R. GALLE	Member, CIML
Belgium	: H. VOORHOF	Member, CIML
Bulgaria	: V. TZAREVSKI S. SIMEONOV	Member, CIML
Cameroon	: S. NOUMSI	Member, CIML
Canada	: R.G. KNAPP	Member, CIML
P.R. of China	: BAI JINGZHONG DAI RUNSHENG FENG LIMING LUO ZHENGZHI	Member, CIML
Cuba	: L. REVUELTA FORMOSO	
Czechoslovakia	: M. CIBÁK J. SYNÁČ M. KURUC	Member, CIML
Denmark	: O. PETERSEN	Member, CIML
Finland	: U. LÄHTEENMÄKI (MRS)	Member, CIML
France	: Ph. BERTRAN	Member, CIML
F. R. of Germany	: M. KOCHSIEK K. BRINKMANN W. GÖGGE H. APEL	Member, CIML
Hungary	: D. BELEDI P. PÁKAY	Member, CIML
Ireland	: P. FARRAGHER	
Japan	: S. HATTORI MONTESSUS (Mrs)	Member, CIML
R. of Korea	: BOCK-GILL SON KEE JOUNG KIM IN HWAN OH	Member, CIML
Monaco	: A. VEGLIA	Member, CIML
Netherlands	: J.A.J. BASTEN G.J. FABER J.G. TUINDER	Member, CIML

Norway	: K. BIRKELAND K. LINDLØV	President, CIML
Poland	: Z. REFEROWSKI	Member, CIML
Portugal	: J. CARTAXO REIS C. DOS SANTOS M. VICENTE A. CRUZ V. RISOTA P. MARTIN	Member, CIML
Saudi Arabia	: KHALED Y. AL-KHALAF ABDULLA AL-HAMOUDI	Member, CIML
Spain	: M. PEÑA MANCHADO	Member, CIML
Sweden	: R. OHLON H. LUNDAHL	Member, CIML
Switzerland	: P. KOCH	Member, CIML
United Kingdom	: S. BENNETT	
United States of America	: S.E. CHAPPELL	V/President, CIML
U.S.S.R.	: V.I. PUSTOVOIT A.S. VISHENKOV	Member, CIML
Yugoslavia	: Z. MARKOVIC M. EZOV	Member, CIML

International Bureau of Legal Metrology :

B. ATHANÉ
F. PETIK
W.H. EMERSON

Delegation of votes:

Mr HASCHE (German D.R.) to Mr KOCHSIEK (Germany, F.R.)
Mr DESIS (Greece) to Mr CARTAXO REIS (Portugal)
Mr PUTERA (Indonesia) to Mr HATTORI (Japan)
Mr AMODEO (Italy) and Mr AYATA (Kenya) to Mr BIRKELAND (Norway)
Mr BENKIRANE (Morocco) and Mr STOICHITOIU (Romania) to Mr BERTRAN (France)

Apologies:

Brazil, Cyprus, Egypt, Ethiopia, India, Israël, P.D.R. of Korea, Pakistan, Sri Lanka, Tanzania, Tunisia.

Notes: a) Mr AFEWORK (Ethiopia) had delegated his vote to Mr BENKIRANE (Morocco) who himself had delegated his vote to Mr BERTRAN (France); it was not felt appropriate to transfer Mr AFEWORK's delegation to Mr BERTRAN.
b) A delegation of vote from Mr DJEUNG KI TCHEUL (P.D.R. of Korea) to Mr BAI JINGZHONG (P.R. of China) arrived after the meeting and was not considered.

Countries that had not nominated a Committee Member:

Algeria, Lebanon.

OPENING ADDRESS

by K. BIRKELAND, President of the Committee

Minister, President, Ladies and Gentlemen, Dear Colleagues,

During the first thirty five years of our Organization's existence the International Committee of Legal Metrology will have met twenty five times, counting the meeting that opens today.

Of those twenty five meetings, eighteen will have been held in Paris, the seat of the Bureau. The seven other occasions will have enabled the Committee to meet in seven other Member States, two of them outside Europe.

Today it is Portugal who receives our Committee.

This country joined OIML only recently, after a long period as a Corresponding Member. But in the course of a few years she has made a remarkable entry onto the European cooperative scene in metrology, with a number of meetings, notably of EUROMET and of WECC, as well as others at the wider international level.

We are all, I am sure, very happy to be able to meet here in Oporto, a shrine of Portuguese history and culture, not least her oenological culture that is known the world over. After all, wine is subjected to a number of measurements, from that of its alcohol content to its insertion into measuring container bottles, and a meeting in Oporto is an occasion for OIML to mix business with pleasure!

My opening address begins, as has become traditional, by marking the changes that have taken place in the composition of our Committee since its last meeting in September 1989.

Those changes are, you will see, extensive.

First, a new Member State, Saudi Arabia, joined OIML at the beginning of this year. Her representative is Dr KHALED Y. AL-KHALAF, Director General of the Saudi-Arabian Standards Organization.

As for the other Member States:

in Austria, Mr GALLE has replaced Mr LEWISCH
in Brazil, Mr MOCSÁNYI has replaced Mr MASAO ITO
in Cameroon, Mr NOUMSI has replaced Mr NDOUGOU
in the Netherlands, Mr BASTEN has replaced Mr FABER
in Poland, Mr REFEROWSKI has replaced Mr MACIEJEWICZ
in Portugal, Mr CARTAXO REIS has replaced Mr CRUZ
in Romania, Mr STOICHITOIU has replaced Mr ISCRULESCU
in the U.S.S.R., Mr PUSTOVOIT has replaced Mr MEKHANNIKOV
in Yugoslavia, Mr MARKOVIC has replaced Mr MEZEK.

To all the former Members of the Committee I have written in the names of all of us, thanking them and wishing them well for the future. To the new Members I have extended the warmest of welcomes, which I am now happy to renew on behalf of all present.

Let us find in these many changes the chance to refresh our ideas and initiatives within the work of the Committee; but we must also guard against the possibility that changes that are too frequent and over numerous will give rise to discontinuities in our activities.

I would like to take this opportunity to raise a matter that is not on the agenda. Since the end of last year our Committee has had only one Vice-President, Dr CHAPPELL, following the call to other duties of Dr MEKHANNIKOV. Normally the Committee should elect its second Vice-President at this meeting, but the numerous changes that I have just listed mean that many of you are meeting within the Committee for the first time. I have concluded that it would be preferable to postpone this election. During the next three days we shall all get to know each other, and I shall then be able to consult you to decide who is or who are the best candidates for this post.

I turn now to our twenty-fifth meeting, to make a few brief references to some of the subjects that we shall have to discuss.

It will not surprise you that I begin with certification.

In 1988, then in 1989, I exerted whatever influence I may have and I tried, from conviction, to persuade you (if indeed it was necessary) to deploy all our resources in the development of the OIML Certificate System. Thanks to an all-round understanding, and to the efforts of all of you who, either personally or through delegated responsibility, contributed to this task, thanks also, I must add, to the members of the Presidential Council, and thanks, of course, to the Bureau, we are on the point of its attainment.

I very much hope that the general rules for the System will be approved by the Committee either tomorrow or on Wednesday. The postal consultation has yielded one negative vote, four abstentions and a very large number of votes of approval; there were many comments, mostly very constructive, and the Bureau has been able to use many of them in the preparation of the final draft.

With democratic grace I accept the negative vote and the abstentions, and I am not trying to change them into yes-votes. I can't help feeling, however, that some of the abstentions arise from the fact that certain Member States do not wish to commit themselves too definitely to working within the System. That is their right, but those abstentions must not exceed the maximum number of six or seven, beyond which, according to the Convention and to the number of Members present, a proposal would be rejected; for it would then be the thirty or so countries who want the System who would be penalized.

With the System supposedly in being, all that will remain to be done will be to get it going as quickly as possible, and why not immediately, even if it is applicable initially to only a very small number of categories of instruments?

Indeed it is only by initially setting it in motion that we shall be able to perfect its operation, step by step.

The launch of the OIML Certificate System will be the completion of an essential stage in the life of our Organization. Its success will depend, however, on our ability to draft Recommendations that are ever better adapted to modern measuring instruments, and to do it ever more efficiently. For that reason in particular a revision of our methods of working becomes necessary, though such a revision would have been needed anyway.

We must, indeed, continue to improve the efficiency of our Organization, not only for our own benefit but for that of the numerous international institutions, regional or otherwise, that are caught up in our work.

It is to be hoped that new methods of working, better adapted to current needs and conditions, will allow us more readily to decide the priorities to be adopted, at the same time enabling us to produce results more quickly.

In fact there is a simultaneous requirement for a complete review of the process by which Recommendations are drafted, and for standardization of their contents, and, no doubt, to look again at the list of our working groups with a view to reorganizing them and why not? reducing their number.

The task was taken in hand two years ago. It has become evident that it is more extensive than could have been predicted, which explains why it will not be possible to complete it at this meeting.

But the reports that the Bureau will introduce will show that the job is well under way.

So the Committee will have to consider and discuss the work proposed or already done, and take some general decisions to guide the Bureau and the Presidential Council in their respective tasks, so that the Committee may reach a final conclusion, at the latest at its next meeting in 1991.

Other subjects that will require our attention:

the approval of new Recommendations, the developing countries, the state of our Organization's finances, and of course the appointment of a Director's Assistant to take up his post next year, on the departure of Mr PETIK.

That, ladies and gentlemen, is the programme of work before you. It is a crowded one, and there will be just sufficient time to deal with all the topics if you accept the need to be as concise as possible in making your contributions, for which I thank you in advance.

To sustain us in this work we shall have some extracurricular activities that will be, I am sure, highly enjoyable.

With those last words I would like, Minister, to ask you kindly to proceed with the opening of the twenty-fifth meeting of the International Committee of Legal Metrology.

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OPENING ADDRESS

BY HIS EXCELLENCY MR LUIS MIRA AMARAL
Minister for Industry and Energy

Mr President, Distinguished Delegates

In the name of the Portuguese Government I welcome you to Portugal and I wish that your work will be fruitful, in the hope that this meeting will help you in your tasks.

You are here in Portugal at a time when Portuguese economy and society have just made extraordinary progress.

As you all know we have been going through a democratization process since the 1974 revolution. At present we have a really stable political democracy and we may say that, as one of the E.E.C. countries, Portugal is, both socially and politically, one of the most stable.

We have a majority government, formed by one party only supported by a four-year legislature. Lately we have experienced an increase in the economic rate of growth, last years figures showing a 5.5 % increase, with an increased investment rate and a low rate of unemployment, that is below 5%.

The Portuguese are optimistic about the future and believe that it is possible to work to attain the standards and economic levels of the most developed countries in the European Community.

As far as the industrial field is concerned we are committed to programmes to bring our industry sectors up to date and to diversify into new industrial areas.

In our industrial programme great emphasis has been given to industrial quality problems, and in this sense the Ministry of Industry and Energy, via Instituto Português da Qualidade, has paid special attention to the metrological aspects.

Portugal has a long tradition in the field of metrology, thus possessing a vast patrimony in this field and being surely one of the richest among European nations.

The roots of standards of weights and measures in our country go back as far as Portuguese nationality itself, with its origins in the XIIth century, when Roman and muslim measuring systems coexisted.

Since then, and up to our times, exceptional and vast documentation regarding the evolution of standards of weights and measures have been produced; its living testimony has conferred on Portugal the privilege of reconstructing its metrological history throughout the eight and a half centuries of its existence as an independent country.

A substantial part of our metrological patrimony can be found in IPQ, the Ministry of Industry's department responsible for the enlargement and coordination of the national metrological sub-system and in charge of establishing in the future, the National Metrological Museum. Some of the most valuable collections of measurement standards and instruments used at different stages of our history, as well as documents related to successive reforms implemented in our country in the area of metrology, were recently exhibited to the public in Lisbon. This "Metrological Exhibition" was held in June this year in Lisbon and was the outcome of an initiative of Instituto Português da Qualidade and the Science Museum of Lisbon Classic University.

Shortly after the closing of this important cultural and scientific event we are pleased to host in our country the foreign delegates attending the 25th meeting of the International Committee of Legal Metrology.

On the 11th July 1984 Portugal acceded to the Convention that established the OIML, though its effective participation in this organization began in only January 1987, when it became the 51st Member State.

I cannot stress too highly OIML's extraordinary activity since its establishment in 1955, bearing in mind its prime role in the harmonization of legal metrology in its member countries in order to overcome technical and administrative problems arising from the use of different measuring instruments, which have sometimes become real obstacles to international trade.

OIML's extraordinary activities in the metrological field, such as the publishing of specialised technical articles in its Bulletin, the drafting and publicising of its Documents and International Recommendations, are responsible not only for the development of testing to be carried out uniformly in metrological control operations, but also, for the improvement in the control of measuring instrument characteristics and metrological quality, which necessarily has its obvious implications in the quality of goods and products produced.

I would like to avail myself of this opportunity to emphasize the importance of adopting an OIML Certificate System in the future, which will be discussed among other subjects.

This Certificate System, once implemented, will bring about very positive results in the development of international trade as it will provide the right conditions for free circulation in Member Countries of measuring instruments that have been approved according to the International Recommendations of that organization.

The submission of the Portuguese candidacy to organize this important meeting is but a reflection of the interest and involvement that my Ministry, by means of IPQ, has devoted to metrological matters. The increase in the use of measuring instruments in trade and in areas such as safety, health, energy saving, the environment and the recognition of the importance of these instruments in economic activity, amply justify making metrology one of the main fields of interest of this Ministry, since the "cost/benefit" advantages in investment in this area are obvious.

Important steps have been taken at the metrological reglementation level through preparing and publishing several metrological control regulations relative to measuring instruments.

Nowadays, over and above the legislation defining the general rules of metrological control and approving the International System of Units as the Legal Measurement System in Portugal, 17 other legal texts have been published which approve some other metrological control regulation.

Now we expect that we may soon be able to complete our legal metrological scenario with 14 other regulations, since they are practically ready for publication.

In the meantime, five other legal texts are in an advanced stage of development.

The publishing of the legal documents envisaged is, on the one hand, the outcome of the obligation to transcribe into Portuguese national law the existing Community legislation about metrological control, and, on the other hand, the adoption of OIML International Recommendations.

Thus the measuring instruments Portuguese industry will be assured as free an entry in EEC markets with the same standing as those of other Member States, pre-supposing the attribution of an EEC Mark, a pattern approval and initial verification by the competent Portuguese authorities.

In order to guarantee Portuguese performance in the Single Market, efforts have been made regarding the improvement of technical and human means necessary for the development of metrological activity.

A great project is under way to establish seven metrological laboratories, of which five are regional ones to support industry directly, while the other two are central. In this, 10 millions ECUs are expected to be invested and several working posts will be created at the highest technical and scientific level.

The central metrological laboratory will be an extension of IPQ's present metrological laboratories and it will be the great centre from which all metrological culture will emanate and where the standards will be kept.

The five regional laboratories will be the metrological component of industry. Thus they will be equipped with working standards of a metrological level below those of the central laboratory.

In order that this mechanism should operate it is necessary to initiate a training programme to prepare metrological technicians technically and scientifically, to enable them to use the equipment at their disposal, to the best effect.

We are sure that this will be the only way to bridge the gap in relation to more highly developed countries, although we know that these countries will not be at a standstill, waiting for us.

To achieve our aim we depend on the efforts and contribution of all those that are already guaranteeing our Portuguese metrological system, the final aim being to render supporting services to the national industry.

To improve industry, Portugal has at present a specific Portuguese industrial development programme financed by E.E.C. funds. Special attention has been given to the industrial quality problem in this programme.

The seven metrological laboratories contemplated in this programme are financed by EEC funds. EEC financing has been given to Portuguese industrial enterprises in order to equip themselves with the apparatus and with quality systems.

Within this programme we are supporting the establishment, development and accreditation of associated metrological laboratories, a major part of which will be created by industrial associations or by non profit-making private institutions complying with the European Standards series 45 000, and which fit into the hierarchy of national standards.

Portugal, with the support of EEC funds, is doing its best to supply the country with a national system of quality management in which the metrological subsystem is inserted to be able to satisfy the Portuguese economic and industrial needs, to achieve full integration in the Single Market.

I wish that this meeting will be extremelly profitable and may contribute to better co-operation between all countries represented here at a metrological level.

In fact OIML has 50 members, and 38 delegations are represented here with a total of 60 participants.

This shows the importance of the matter under discussion and the keen interest with which we will follow your tasks.

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Mr BIRKELAND thanked the Minister:

Thank you, Excellency, for opening officially our twenty-fifth Committee meeting. Thank you also for your interest in metrology and your realization its importance. We are all very impressed by the great effort you are making in this country to improve very efficiently your metrological capacity. We are sure you will harvest very good results, very shortly.

Mr BIRKELAND then gave the floor to Mr CRUZ, Director of Metrology at the Portuguese Institute for Quality.

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ADDRESS BY Mr ANTONIO CRUZ

Mr President, Ladies and Gentlemen, Members of the Committee,

On behalf of IPQ I have the honour and the pleasure to address you with a few words. Let me introduce you to some of the latest developments in our Institute and in the metrology system in Portugal. As you probably already know, at least by the last OIML Bulletin of June, in Portugal, metrology is part of the national quality management system, and a general strategy in this field is in place for a better rate of achievement and performance in all economic activities. Portugal is part of the European Community and 1992 is considered as a major turning point in the integration of the economies and the creation of a Single Market. Quality is for us a key to success in this unified Market: new structures, new philosophies are being developed to this end.

New structures are growing step by step, stone by stone, to strengthen the system. New testing laboratories and calibration facilities are being built. The accreditation activities are in an intensive period of application and assessment. Coming back to metrology, we are now finalizing the planning of the new laboratory facilities of IPQ. A completely new central laboratory for metrology will be operative in 1993 with around 8 000 m² as laboratory area in Lisbon and about 2 000 m² in the Oporto region. The total cost of this new investment is around 30 millions US\$, including equipment. Some of the metrology fields, like, for example, electricity, acoustics and ionising radiations, will remain outside our Institute; however, the investment in maintenance and development in these fields is also supervised and coordinated by the IPQ project. At the same time five new regional laboratories are also under construction: Oporto in the North, Coimbra in the Centre, Lisbon, Evora in the Alentejo region, and Faro in Algarve, will receive these five new laboratories concerned with legal metrology. It represents a total investment of 22 millions US\$, to be ready at the end of 1993. All these projects are financed by a general programme to develop the Portuguese industry, assisted by the EEC. In the regulatory field, a new decree-law was published last month on the 20th of September, introducing the possibility of the full participation of private initiative in metrological control, for example for verification by manufacturers or by inspection bodies. Both must be previously accredited for that purpose. Another important change was introduced in our law: the fees from metrological operations

are collected by the Institute and applied directly in the IPQ budget without passing through the state treasury. IPQ also collects 20 % of the fees from the legal-metrology activities in other bodies. That percentage is equivalent, for example for the year 1989, to a total of 1.5 million US\$.

I want now to thank you all for coming and I wish you the best possible success for this meeting, and also for your national or personal projects. I hope in the very near future to receive you all in our new facilities, and perhaps to host one of the OIML's next meetings in Lisbon.

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M. BIRKELAND then gave the floor to the Representative of Saudi Arabia.

ADDRESS BY Dr KHALED Y. AL-KHALAF

Mr President, Ladies and Gentlemen,

It is my pleasure to be present here despite the hard circumstances through which our areas are now passing. I am glad to be here to represent the Saudi Arabian Standards Organization, known as SASO, which is in charge of all standardization activities in Saudi Arabia; in the last four years it has also been in charge of the formulation of standards and regulations for metrological activities for the Gulf Co-operation Council Countries, which is comprised of six Countries, Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Bahrain, United Arab Emirates, Qatar and Oman. We are in charge of regulating legal and industrial metrology, and we have recently developed some primary standards in various fields of metrology, covering both legal and industrial metrology. We have some technical co-operation programmes with some of our friendly countries. We have a co-operation programme with the PTB in Germany. We are also having some metrological co-operation with the British side. We have also had a long co-operation with the Japanese Co-operation Council, which is covering general quality control and electrical and electronic standardization, and also metrology. It is our hope that by joining this prestigious Organization we will be able to contribute together to international harmonization. Thank you very much.

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Roll-call of delegates – Quorum

After these speeches, the roll of delegates was called; it was established that 37 Members of the Committee were present or represented out of a total of 48. The statutory quorum of three-quarters was thus attained.

Adoption of the agenda

The Committee adopted the following agenda:

1. Approval of the minutes of the Twenty-fourth meeting of the Committee
 2. Member States and Corresponding Members
 - 2.1. New accessions - Expected accessions
 - 2.2. The situation of some Member States
 3. Finance
 - 3.1. Approval of the Auditor's report for 1989
 - 3.2. The financial position in 1990 and 1991
 4. Staff of the Bureau
 - 4.1. Replacement of an Assistant Director retiring from the Bureau in May 1991
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 - 7.3. Adoption of International Recommendations
 - 7.4. A method by which the Committee might approve certain revised International Recommendations (R 74 and R 76) at its 26th meeting in 1991
 8. Long-term policy of the Organisation
 9. Developing countries
 10. OIML seminars
 11. Report on the activities of BIML (October 1989-September 1990)
 12. Other business
 13. Date and place of the next meeting
- Decisions and Resolutions

MINUTES

1. APPROVAL OF THE MINUTES OF THE TWENTY-FOURTH MEETING OF THE COMMITTEE

The draft minutes were approved without change.

2. MEMBER STATES AND CORRESPONDING MEMBERS

2.1. New accessions – Expected accessions

The recent accession of Saudi Arabia having already been mentioned, the Bureau had nothing to add on the subject, other than that a number of countries, such as Mexico, had made it known that they were considering the possibility of joining OIML, though no more details were then available.

2.2. The situation of some Member States

Mr KOCHSIEK informed the Committee that on that very day, the 3rd October 1990, Germany was being reunified. Every branch of the law, including that of metrology, of the Federal Republic of Germany would therefore apply thenceforth in the former German Democratic Republic. The PTB was responsible for the scientific aspects of metrology and, as concerned legal metrology, for pattern approvals, whereas the authorities of the eleven Lander that had hitherto constituted the FRG were responsible for verifications. The scientific activities of the former ASMW would be taken over by the PTB, while the ASMW's former responsibility for verification would be assumed by the institutions of the five new Lander that would be constituted in the territory of the former GDR. From that day forward the regulations of the FRG were applicable in the former GDR. The PTB would continue to be sited at Brunswick and Berlin; however, the ASMW's centre in Berlin would become PTB's third site. The consequences for OIML would be the following:

- Dr HASCHE would cease to be a member of CIML,
- from 1991 the unified Germany would pay a single contribution to OIML, equal to that paid up to then by the FRG,
- the responsibilities for Pilot Secretariats and Reporting Secretariats assumed hitherto by the FRG and the GDR would be assumed by Germany if the Committee was in agreement,
- Germany's member status in other OIML Secretariats would be decided later, after the reorganization of PTB that the absorption of the ASMW would make necessary.

Mr BIRKELAND wished the German delegation every success in the unification. He ruled that, for that meeting of the Committee, the two German Member States (FRG and GDR) would still be, and for the last time, counted separately for the quorum and in the voting, since the Committee had not been officially notified of the reunification before the opening of the meeting.

Mr ATHANÉ then indicated that Romania had begun to pay the arrears of its contributions to OIML and that no Member State was in a situation that called for the attention of the Committee.

3. FINANCE

3.1. Approval of the auditor's report for 1989

The auditor's report for 1989 was approved without comment.

3.2. The financial position in 1990 and 1991

Mr ATHANÉ said that the financial estimates sent out at the end of 1989 remained current, with the following modifications:

- the renovation of the Organization's headquarters, intended for 1989 and 1990, had been delayed, which had led to a partial transfer of the expenditure from 1989 to 1990, and then from 1990 to 1991,
- certain receipts (rebate of tax by the French government) which were to have been received in 1989, had been carried forward to 1990,
- the accession of Saudi Arabia entailed an increase in receipts of about 110 000 French francs for 1990 (entry fee and annual contribution).

Mr ATHANÉ also said that the increase in the rate of inflation caused by the Gulf crisis would have practically no effect in 1990, but would make its full impact in 1991.

In reply to a question from Mr REFEROWSKI, Mr ATHANÉ confirmed that the financial situation had allowed the recruitment at the beginning of 1990 of a tenth officer in the Bureau, Mr Édouard Weber, whose main task was the editing of OIML documents written in French; he was giving every satisfaction and took a lively interest in his work.

The predictions of income and expenditure for 1991 should be sent out at the end of November or the beginning of December 1990. Those predictions would take the following facts into account:

- an increase in inflation for which it was then impossible to give a figure; the Organization's reserves should be sufficient to withstand a rate of inflation of 5% or 6 % (compared with a figure of 3.5 % used by the Eighth Conference in deciding the budget for 1989 to 1992) and for the time being the Committee was not being asked for an increase in the budget; the situation would have to be considered carefully at the Committee's next meeting,
- the accession of Saudi Arabia (a gain of one contributory share) and the reunification of Germany (a loss of two contributory shares) led to a loss of one share; the individual contributions of the Member States for 1991 would show a rise therefore of about 1 %.

4. STAFF OF THE BUREAU

4.1. Replacement of an Assistant Director retiring from the Bureau in May 1991

Mr BIRKELAND reminded the Committee that Mr Petik would retire from the Bureau on 31st May 1991 and that ten candidates (*) for the post that he would vacate had been nominated by, between them, seven Member States; those candidacies had been studied by an ad hoc group formed by the Committee, which had met on Wednesday 3rd October after the plenary session; the group had accepted the criteria specified by the Bureau in its enquiry: a thorough prior knowledge of OIML's activities and a perfect mastery of the Russian language. While recognising the merits of all the candidates, the ad hoc group had decided to draw up a short list of three names: Mr Szilvassy, Mr Synac and Mr Vishenkov (in alphabetical order of the French names of their countries of origin). By means of a secret ballot in which 37 Members of the Committee or their representatives took part the Committee elected Mr VISHENKOV as the new Director's Assistant, by 26 votes in the first round. The formal date for the Director's new assistant to take up his post was 1st June 1991, but it could be advanced or delayed by agreement between the person concerned and the Director of the Bureau, to suit the convenience of either party.

(*) Belgium: M. P. Degavre – Bulgaria: Mrs J. Popova et Mr S. Simeonov – Hungary: Mr A. Szilvassy – Poland: Mr J. Hruban – Romania: Mr V. Calcan, Mr D. Stoichitoiu and Mr A. Mihalache – Czechoslovakia: Mr J. Synac – USSR: Mr A.S. Vishenkov.

4.2. Staff members whose contracts expire before the end of 1992

Mr ATHANÉ said that Mr Thulin, Assistant Director, would retire during 1992, and that the Committee would have to elect his successor at its meeting in 1991; the Bureau would shortly be seeking candidacies with that end in view.

4.3. Other business

There was no other business concerning the staff of the Bureau.

5. CERTIFICATION

5.1. Approval of the document "OIML Certificate System for Measuring Instruments"

Mr BIRKELAND stressed the importance of this item of the agenda, which had been the subject of numerous discussions and much correspondence. He asked his colleagues on the Committee to make their last comments before the document was submitted to a vote by the Committee. He indicated that in addition to the draft "OIML Certificate System for Measuring Instruments" the Committee had to take into account the votes and comments set out in an accompanying paper, a note from Japan on the System, and the Bureau's proposed amendment about the designation of "issuing authorities" following remarks made by some Member States.

Mr PETERSEN explained Denmark's abstention by referring to a growing bureaucratic tendency that had appeared in the drafts over the past two years: the registering of certificates, fees to be paid, etc.. Moreover the "issuing authorities" were insufficiently well defined. Was it necessary to follow exactly all the requirements described in the paper? A national system had been established in Denmark on the basis of earlier descriptions of the proposed OIML System, but the new draft no longer corresponded to Denmark's system. Would the national system have to be changed, or could the OIML System be adapted to national requirements?

Mr VEGLIA declared that his country's authorities were convinced that the OIML System could function satisfactorily only if there was a high level of mutual confidence between the Member States of OIML. He suggested therefore that inter-comparison exercises be organized to verify that the OIML Recommendations and the test procedures that they had to include were being properly applied. Those intercomparisons could be arranged bilaterally or multilaterally, as was done for the exercise with respect to R 76 (EFTA plus Denmark), and OIML would take responsibility for distributing the results and conclusions to the Member States.

Mr BIRKELAND expressed his agreement and stressed that the launch of the System would certainly give rise to numerous other activities, of which some would have the particular aim of creating that necessary mutual trust.

Mr OHLON lent his support to the System on the condition that it came into operation quickly. He drew attention to the new directions in which the work of Western Europe was heading, with the directives under the "new approach", the accompanying European standards, and the activities of the newly created EOTC. He thought that the OIML System ought to be able to operate in these new contexts: for example, the pattern evaluation envisaged by the directives would be done by registered bodies who would be able to certify either that an instrument satisfied the essential requirements of the directive or that it was in conformity with the accompanying standard. The registration of those bodies would have to be done according to established rules, and those bodies would have to satisfy well-defined criteria. In the OIML draft the require-

ments applicable to the test laboratories were given by reference to the guides published by ISO and IEC. In Europe those requirements were likewise given by reference to European standards. The OIML System would have to make dual reference, so that the certificates issued by countries outside Europe and those issued by the European countries were compatible and mutually acceptable.

Mr BIRCH indicated that his country's abstention in the postal vote was due to the fact that at that time the various Australian organizations concerned had not finished their consultations. Now Australia was in agreement with the principles, but that day's debate, though dealing with the details, was extremely important to maintain the integrity of the System. In that sense the amendment proposed by the Bureau could be acceptable. However, certain details still created difficulties for Australia; they were not perhaps important enough to justify an abstention, but made some clarification necessary. First there was the definition of the "applicant": it was too general and allowed more than one person or company to submit one and the same instrument, in the same country or in different countries, to obtain certificates. It would be preferable that a certificate could be issued only to an instrument manufacturer, not to representatives or importers: in Australia the same instrument could be imported by more than one importer. Mr BIRCH also shared Mr Petersen's fears of the System's becoming too bureaucratic. Moreover he would like to see the requirements that the laboratories would have to satisfy replaced by or at least extended by requirements about the way in which those laboratories could be accredited. He stressed the benefits that could stem from the System by an increase in cooperation between national metrological bodies, but he insisted that there was a difficulty that would still have to be faced, that of the conformity of individual instruments to the models tested.

Mr BIRKELAND recognized the importance of the difficulties that had been cited; however, he thought that it was difficult to solve in advance all the problems that would arise when the System was put into effect. The most pragmatic approach was therefore to launch the System as soon as possible for a very restricted number of categories of instruments, and to resolve the problems as and when they presented themselves. He also thought that the regional and international bodies concerned with certification would, on their side, resolve many of the general problems that arose, and that OIML could benefit from those common efforts.

Mr BRINKMANN drew attention to an inconsistency between the basic document and the amendment proposed by the Bureau on the designation of the issuing authorities.

Mr OHLON thought that the Bureau's amendment was not entirely logical and should not be accepted immediately. He thought moreover that the expression "issuing authority" was not a particularly happy one.

Mr BASTEN said that a link should be established with the regular pattern-approving authorities: that would make everything clear, for in every country those authorities were clearly defined and identified.

Mr CHAPPELL referred back to a remark by Mr BIRCH: certainly the manufacturer was the first to be concerned with the System; however, in many countries there were distributors who marketed, in their own names, instruments manufactured by others: the manufacturer could even be unknown. As regarded the test laboratories and their possible accreditation, the fact must be considered that a manufacturer could request a certificate in a country that observed certain rules in that regard, if he knew that he might wish to use the certificate in other countries that applied the same rules as a condition for the recognition of the certificates. In fact an aim of the System

was to help manufacturers obtain pattern approval and to help the pattern-approval authorities in their work. For OIML the advantage would be that its work would be more widely disseminated and used, provided that it was good enough to be used in the System. Another advantage for the national laboratories and other testing bodies would be a growth in mutual confidence.

Mr BIRCH thanked Mr Chappell for his reaction but did not think that he was completely satisfied, for the definition of applicant was too loose and could allow different people or companies to present simultaneous applications for the same instrument.

Mr BASTEN reminded the meeting that the Netherlands had already made the same observation.

Mr BIRKELAND thought that that kind of problem could quickly be resolved in the experience acquired when the System was put into application.

Mr GALLE was of the view that it was necessary to begin work on the basis of the present document: only then would the points that needed to be modified or developed become apparent; it was impossible to foresee every contingency.

Mr BERTRAN did not think that there could be disagreement with the System's objectives, for it aimed to lighten both the work of the national services and the load on the manufacturers; however, France's abstention was due to the fact that, before the System could be put into operation, mutual confidence between the laboratories and the metrological institutions would have to be established; if the System was launched too soon, some countries would accept the OIML certificates issued by the laboratories that they already knew and in which they had confidence, but would reject the certificates emanating from other laboratories; it would therefore be a "two-speed" system.

Mr BIRKELAND recognized that M. BERTRAN was right in theory but thought that it was impossible to wait for general mutual confidence between countries, which would be very difficult to achieve absolutely; in fact the System would help to create that mutual confidence.

Mr KOCH also thought that mutual trust should be built up step by step and, thanks to the System, countries would learn to have confidence in each other, even if such confidence was not there at the beginning.

Mr BAI JINGHZONG expressed China's general support for the OIML System; he thought that it should be extended so that a certificate attested not only that an instrument conformed to the OIML requirements, but that the manufacturer was competent to build the instrument that was the subject of the certificate.

Mr BIRKELAND said that he wished to conclude the discussion by reminding the Committee that it was to be called upon to approve a document that was not to be considered as being engraved on tablets of stone: on the contrary it was a living document that the Committee could improve and extend later, both in its content and in the manner of its application. An ad hoc group, or the Presidential Council, could be asked to monitor the application of the System with the help of the Bureau, and to resolve any difficulties that arose. Means such as the Bulletin could be used to make the problems and their solution known. Many of the comments made during the session would be very useful in improving the System; however, the changes proposed in the session had not been studied at leisure and it would be better to put them aside for the present and submit them and others to the Committee at its next meeting.

The COMMITTEE raised no objection to those conclusions and, by a vote of which the result is given in Annex 1, approved the document "OIML Certificate System for Measuring Instruments".

5.2. OIML International Recommendations applicable within the OIML Certificate System

Mr ATHANÉ reminded the Committee that it had requested the Bureau to study this matter. A preliminary analysis had been submitted to the Presidential Council and to the Pilot Secretariats concerned at the beginning of 1990. That analysis, corrected and enlarged, was now before the Committee. Each Recommendation (or group of related Recommendations) had been studied with reference to the criteria set out below:

- the specification of the metrological requirements must be such that they may be interpreted uniformly,
- there must be methods and test equipment specified to verify that a requirement is satisfied,
- there must (generally) be a model test report.

Some Recommendations were, in the Bureau's estimation, immediately applicable to the System. For many others the drafting of a test report would make them applicable and could be done quickly. For the remainder a more complete revision was necessary. The Pilot Secretariats and Reporting Secretariats concerned with the development of test reports or the revision of Recommendations, or with both, had been contacted by the Bureau, and for the most part the reactions had been positive: the work had already started or would start soon. The Bureau would certainly do its best to help and guide the Secretariats in this task. It was noticeable that the development of test reports sometimes revealed weaknesses or a lack of clarity in the drafting of the requirements.

Mr ATHANÉ added that the analysis had its subjective aspects where remarks had been made about certain Recommendations or where a judgement had been made on the possibility of the uniform application of the requirements. Those judgements were in no way final and the Bureau was prepared to discuss them with the Secretariats concerned and to change its opinion where appropriate.

Mr CHAPPELL said that he had already contacted the Bureau about the remarks made about some Recommendations dealing with pollution: the Secretariat certainly intended that those Recommendations should become applicable to the System as quickly as possible. In response to a question from Mr CHAPPELL, the BUREAU indicated that in many cases the addition of a model test report to a Recommendation by the normal process of revision of Recommendations could be done according to an accelerated timetable: for example, two months might be sufficient for approval simultaneously at the Pilot stage and the Reporting stage, and three months for the postal enquiry among members of the Committee. Thus it was not impossible that some new Recommendations might become applicable by the next meeting of the Committee. The Bureau would write to the Secretariats on the subject and suggest a timetable.

Mr BRINKMANN thought that the Bureau's analysis was sometimes rather optimistic: often a revision would be required rather than the simple addition of a test report. He added that in his view all the currently active Secretariats ought to receive instruction on how a Recommendation should be drafted to make it immediately applicable to the System, so that the new Recommendations that would be approved in the coming years would be immediately applicable.

Mr BIRKELAND supported that proposal, but he reminded the Members of the Committee that they had a role to play in guiding the national experts working for OIML.

5.3. Other actions necessary to the effective operation of the system

Mr BIRKELAND mentioned all the parties, apart from the OIML Secretariats, who would have to be informed in a particular country about the operation and the development of the System. Some countries had already distributed information about it; such information could be sent to the Bureau and transmitted to all the Member States with encouragement to act in like manner.

Mr BIRKELAND then pointed to the need to keep all the information about certificates issued under the System up to date. He referred to a proposal from the Bureau to establish a computerized database for the certificates registered by the Bureau. The latter had already (for a price of about 10 000 French francs) commissioned a study that had produced the figure of about 100 000 francs to establish such a database, not including the possible purchase of another computer and printer. It was really up to the Member States to consider whether they would want to ask the Bureau for information about certificates, sufficient to justify the creation of the database. The decision was not needed urgently, but it had to be realized that if no positive decision was taken for some years there could be a lot of work to be done in catching up.

Mr BASTEN thought that in principle such a database could be very useful. However, it could contain only limited information about the precise types of instrument that had received certificates. Only the certificate *accompanied by* the test report (with its annexes) would give sufficient information to permit verification of the conformity of an individual instrument to the model that had been certified. In the model certificate now available the identification of the instrument had to be accommodated in a single line: that would nearly always be insufficient. A database as described by the Bureau would no doubt be adequate to start with, but its expansion to embrace more information would be needed very soon. The countries of Western Europe were currently studying the matter under the auspices of WELMEC; they envisaged including the whole of the contents of the European pattern approval statement in the database.

Mr KHALED Y. AL-KHALAF thought that the establishment of a database for OIML certificates was extremely important. It would be needed sooner or later, so why not start it straight away? But it would have to be established in advance that every Member State would have equal right of access to the central database and to any local databases that might be created.

Mr BIRKELAND confirmed the need to assure every Member State of the right of equal access.

In reply to a question from Mr PETERSEN the BUREAU indicated that the magnitude of the registration fee that would be payable would have to be fixed to take account of the costs of making use of the files or of database maintained by the Bureau. If there was a demand from the Member States and, perhaps, from manufacturers that was sufficient to justify a computerized database, then its cost would have to be covered by the registration fees. For the moment the estimate for the registration fee was between 100 and 200 French francs per certificate, on the basis of a restricted number of files being maintained and consulted manually by the Bureau.

Mr EMERSON suggested that the Committee would have to decide whether the information to be contained in the database should be limited to that contained in the certificates, which would require only a simple database of modest dimensions, or whether all the descriptive information contained in the test report should also be included. The latter choice would require a change in the rules of operation of the System, for currently it was not envisaged that the Bureau would receive copies of test reports. Furthermore, would the OIML System not require a description of the pattern that was the subject of the certificate, even if such a description was less detailed than that contained in some national pattern approval certificates? Again, would the Member States wish to have direct access to the database or would they be satisfied with indirect access via the Bureau? Replies to those questions were needed before a decision could be made as to whether a database was desirable and, if it was, as to what form it should take.

Mr OHLON doubted the usefulness of a database; when a manufacturer submitted an OIML certificate in support of a request for pattern approval, that certificate would be accompanied by the test report containing all the necessary information, including a complete description of the model that had been certified. What additional information of any value could be obtained from a database?

Mr BIRKELAND recognized that there were many questions that required study before a decision could be taken on the subject.

Mr BASTEN agreed with Mr Ohlon that the database would be unnecessary when studying an OIML certificate and its accompanying test report with a view to approving the pattern. The database could, however, be useful in supplying more global information, for example statistics about the issuing authorities, the manufacturers etc. participating in the OIML System. For that, direct access would be unnecessary and a manually operated database might be sufficient.

Mr BIRKELAND thought that caution was needed with regard to the information that could be included in a database, especially if, for example, the manufacturers had access to it.

Mr CHAPPELL agreed entirely and stressed the confidential nature of some information.

Responding to a question from Mr KHALED Y. AL-KHALAF, the BUREAU indicated that it had not produced a list of suppliers or manufacturers of measuring instruments; such lists would be very difficult to compile and maintain, given the very large numbers of manufacturers of instruments, and of types. No doubt such information was obtainable at national or regional level through manufacturers' associations. The Bureau had confined itself to producing a list of suppliers of verification equipment, which was very useful to the services of legal metrology.

Mr BERTRAN thought that it was too soon, not only to take a decision but even to choose directions: one or two years' experience of the System were needed before the Bureau would be able to say how it, the Member States, the metrological services, the manufacturers etc. might benefit from the creation of a database.

Mr BIRKELAND thought that the discussion might end with those words, but he urged his colleagues to think about their future needs and inform the Bureau.

6. WORKING METHOD OF OIML SECRETARIATS

6.1. Revision of the procedure for the drafting of International Recommendations and Documents

Mr BIRKELAND reminded the Committee of the importance of this subject in the framework of the OIML Certificate System. However, a revision of the working method was necessary in itself, to improve the efficiency of OIML, not only for its own benefit but also for that of the numerous international and regional organizations that used its work. On the basis of earlier decisions of the Conference and of the Committee the Bureau had studied the situation in detail, had reported on it to the Presidential Council, had made an analysis of the differences that appeared to exist between the new directives for the work of ISO and IEC and the existing working method of OIML, and had made proposals for new working methods for OIML, including two draft resolutions (see Annex 2) for the consideration of the Committee.

A first draft of a resolution had been sent to Committee Members, and on the basis of comments on it received the Bureau had produced a second draft and annexed to it another resolution. That second draft had also been the subject of comments, of which some had been made orally before the meeting of the Committee. Mr BIRKELAND thought that it might be too detailed and restrictive, perhaps following too closely the directives of ISO and IEC, not all of which were exactly applicable to OIML.

Mr BIRKELAND added that a proposal from the USA (see Annex 3), which represented a kind of alternative to the Bureau's draft, had just been distributed to those present; it was much more general and proposed some general principles to be observed in drafting the new working methods. The Committee therefore had to consider how to instruct the Bureau to proceed in the matter, either by giving it very precise instructions, or contenting itself with laying down general guidelines.

Mr CHAPPELL thought that the Bureau's analysis was very good; it well demonstrated that the Organization could not continue to work along exactly the same lines. However, the proposals contained in the draft resolution were in some cases too detailed or too restricting. The important question of coordination between working groups had not been resolved and the role of Committee Members was ambiguous. It was to be feared, moreover, that the Bureau's proposals would make the participation of countries in certain regions of the world difficult, particularly those that were geographically distant from Europe. Mr CHAPPELL thought that his proposal, being more flexible, could lead to solutions better adapted to the problems encountered. Finally he stressed that some of his colleagues on the Committee, one of whom was Mr Knapp, had helped him in developing that contribution.

Mr PETERSEN also insisted that the Bureau's analysis was of great value; as regarded the draft resolution proposed by the Bureau he had no fundamental criticisms apart from a few minor inconsistencies. The USA's proposal set out some general considerations, some preconditions to be followed in a detailed resolution; it was difficult therefore to find a middle way: in fact the Bureau's proposal and that of the USA were complementary. The draft resolution would have to be improved and no doubt extended, but it could not be replaced by that of the USA, which did not give instructions to the Bureau that were sufficiently clear to guide it in its future task.

Mr KOCH was of the same opinion as Mr Petersen: the USA's proposal was a framework needing completion by the addition of detailed instructions.

Despite the brief interval in which he had been able to study the USA's proposal, Mr BERTRAN thought that it was certainly very good; however, it was less operational than the draft resolution. Perhaps the text of a proposal could be synthesized by grafting onto the draft resolution some of the more especially important points of the USA's proposal, mainly its paragraph 4. Finally Mr BERTRAN expressed some doubts about the Bureau's proposal to assign the writing of a first preliminary draft to a small international group, and not to a single person; in fact that initial task was always performed by an individual expert.

On that last point, Mr ATHANÉ said that the Bureau's aim was to ensure that the first preliminary draft could not be distributed officially to the collaborating Member States, nor to the liaising international or regional organizations, before a small ad hoc group of experts from different countries had studied the draft and had assured itself, at least by correspondence, that the text was written in language that was clear and that the subject had been treated in a manner that conformed to OIML's needs. Too often first preliminary drafts that could be understood only with great difficulty or that were badly drafted, or that even contained gross errors, were distributed officially by the country responsible for a Secretariat, having been checked neither by the Bureau nor by the collaborating states; and such practices were damaging to OIML as a whole.

Mr BERTRAN was satisfied by that explication, but he asked that the text of the draft resolution be made clear on that point.

Mr REFEROWSKI found the Bureau's analysis very good and wished that it remain the basis for the revision of the working methods. The USA's proposal was in fact a working philosophy, whereas the Bureau's draft resolution already proposed detailed solutions. It was difficult to make a synthesis of these two proposals, each written in different language and from different viewpoints. He preferred that the USA's proposal be taken as a point of departure.

Mr KNAPP confirmed that he supported the general principles of the USA's proposal, in the drafting of which he had a part. It should be seen as a philosophy, a general approach to the problems to be solved in the practical realization of new work directives. He was, too, completely in agreement with Mr Birkeland in recognizing the importance of the subject to OIML. The Bureau's draft resolution left him with a feeling of dissatisfaction, and he was not sure that it was always appropriate to copy the directives of ISO and IEC. The role of a Member of CIML was quite different from that of a technical committee (TC) of ISO. To give CIML the responsibility of a TC was not acceptable from his point of view. The legal role of OIML, which was not an organization for the production of standards to be applied voluntarily, had to be borne in mind.

Mr BIRKELAND approved of that viewpoint and recalled that the present working method had in fact been copied from that of ISO nearly twenty years earlier; perhaps some of the perceived defects were due to that fact, as the role of OIML was not exactly the same as that of ISO.

Mr OHLON asked himself the same questions as Mr Knapp. In fact an ISO TC was made up of specialists in the subject being treated. The CIML could not be considered as being composed of specialists in all the technical subjects that OIML was called upon to deal with. Also, in ISO the chairmen had to attend the meetings of the TC, which would be impossible at CIML level. Something resembling the former Pilot Secretariats would have to be retained to act as TCs. One improvement to be conserved was the creation of working groups to prepare drafts for the subcommittees; on that point the USA's proposal needed to be completed.

Mr PETERSEN agreed with Mr Ohlon on the whole. He added that the respective responsibilities of the future working groups ought to be better specified and described: not everyone was fully aware of ISO's working rules!

Mr BRINKMANN agreed with the general principles that had been put forward, but he had some hesitation in accepting some of the practical solutions proposed by the Bureau. In particular a working level between the subcommittees (or reporting secretariats) and the CIML would have to be retained. In the USA's proposal, cooperation between OIML and the international, and especially regional (CEN and CENELEC), standards organizations should have been stressed. Their activities in the field of measuring instruments was increasing; a new strategy, or new ways of collaborating, would have to be found. The immediate reciprocal exchange of information about new projects, and the possibility of OIML's using international or regional standards, were both necessary.

Mr KOCH thought that the notion of the first preliminary draft should be reviewed. It was not just a question of editorial blemishes; the aims of an OIML text ought to be clearly settled in advance. Also, should the work focus on the instruments currently in use at the time that the drafting of a text began, or should an attempt be made to take into account the instruments that would be used in the near future? Before distributing a first preliminary draft, every secretariat ought to submit its proposal to an ad hoc group of experts.

Mr BAI JINGZHONG made two remarks: effectively the OIML working method should be revised to make it more efficient, and to that end inspiration could be sought in the directives of ISO and IEC. However, the CIML could not be compared with an ISO TC: the intergovernmental character of OIML prevented it. OIML's field of work could be divided into a number of subfields for which responsibility could be attributed to group with the task of writing OIML Recommendations in those subfields.

Mr CHAPPELL thought that the Bureau's draft resolution contained none of the necessary general principles, and that the practical solutions proposed could be understood in ways that diverged. According to the USA's understanding of some of them they would lead to a reduced participation by that country, and no doubt by some others, in the work of OIML. There was certainly a parallel between ISO and IEC on the one hand and OIML on the other; there were also differences in their objectives, which meant that certain solutions applicable to ISO and IEC could present immediate difficulties if applied in OIML. A crucial point for the USA was the transparency of OIML work: too much independence in the working groups could prejudice that transparency. Again, over-strict rules for compulsory attendance at meetings by P-members could be impossible to apply. The OIML working directives would have to take account of the very restricted human and financial resources of the metrological administrations of OIML Member States. Mr CHAPPELL concluded with the request that the general principles that he had tried to put forward in writing should be used as a basis for future draft directives for the technical work of OIML.

Mr PETERSEN wondered whether a decision should not first be taken as to whether the analysis made by the Bureau was entirely acceptable to the Committee: if it was, it could serve as the basis for the continuation of the work and the conclusions of the draft resolution were reasonably good.

Mr BIRKELAND did not think that the analysis required the Committee's formal approval: the analysis could be good and the conclusions drawn from it bad!

Mr OHLON thought that it was premature to adopt a resolution that was too detailed. Could an ad hoc group not be instructed to help the Bureau in a new draft to be approved at the next meeting of the Committee?

Mr BIRKELAND agreed that a resolution should not be adopted immediately, but he thought that some written conclusions should reflect the content of the discussion and could be taken by the Bureau as the basis for future work. He added that the Presidential Council could play the role of the ad hoc group proposed by Mr OHLON. He thought that the Committee would have to be in a position to take final decisions about the new work directives at its next meeting.

Mr CHAPPELL supported that last opinion: the revision of the working method was now urgent and could not be postponed beyond the next meeting of the Committee. He suggested that the Members of the CIML concerned made their views known to the Committee as quickly as possible by correspondence. He thought that the Bureau could usefully follow the general principles that he had tried to formulate in his written proposal, even if, for lack of time and because it had been proposed during the session, that proposal could not be formally debated and adopted. He asked that, in the decisions of the Committee, the Bureau's proposal (draft resolution CIML 1990 item 6.1.b - see Annex 2), according to which the Committee instructed the Presidential Council and the Bureau to think about the optimal division of OIML's general work programme between different working groups, should not be forgotten.

6.2. Standard contents of Recommendations

Mr BIRKELAND reminded the Committee that the Bureau had distributed a draft on this subject to all Members in August 1990 with a request that comments be sent to the Bureau before 1990.12.31. He did not propose therefore that the draft be discussed at the meeting. The comments would be compiled by the Bureau and submitted to the Presidential Council at its next meeting. A final draft could then be sent to all the Members of the Committee for approval by correspondence or at the next meeting.

7. WORK OF THE SECRETARIATS

7.1. State of progress of work

The paper entitled "State of progress of the work of OIML Secretariats", brought up to date on 1990.9.30, had been sent by post to all Members of the Committee, and spare copies were available to anyone attending the meeting.

7.2. Particular Secretariats

The BUREAU announced the following:

- the titles of the Reporting Secretariats of SP 14, "Acoustics and vibration", would be changed in accordance with the results of the enquiries made by the Bureau at the request of SP 14,
- the United Kingdom was no longer in a position to assume responsibility for Reporting Secretariat SP 16-Sr 4, "Dosimetric methods of measurement in the industrial use of ionizing radiations", and had indicated that the USA would no doubt agree to take it over.

Mr CHAPPELL confirmed his country's willingness to take on the responsibility and said that a work programme would soon be ready. The new programme might differ little from the initial programme proposed by the UK.

Mr BENNETT spoke of his disappointment at having had to give notice that, because of the unavailability of appropriate members of staff, the NPL had to abandon that responsibility; he gave his assurance that his country would continue to take part in the work.

7.3. Approval of International Recommendations

By a vote of which the results are given in Annex 1, the Committee approved the following International Recommendations for immediate publication and formal submission to the Ninth Conference:

- Metrological regulation of load cells,
- High-precision line measures of length,
- Indicating pressure gauges, vacuum gauges and pressure-vacuum gauges,
- Recording pressure gauges, vacuum gauges and pressure-vacuum gauges,
- Instruments for measuring vehicle-exhaust emissions,
- Atomic absorption spectrometers for measuring metal pollutants in water.

It was stated that the two Recommendations on pressure gauges would be printed in the form of a compilation in which the Recommendation R 94, sanctioned by the Eighth Conference, would also be included.

7.4. A method by which the Committee might approve certain revised International Recommendations (R 74 and R 76) at its 26th meeting in 1991

Mr BIRKELAND said that two Recommendations, R 74 and R 76 on weighing instruments, were being revised and that it was extremely important, not only for OIML but also for the regional organizations that used its work, that the drafts be approved by the Committee at its next meeting.

With account taken of the state of progress of the revisions, that would be possible only if the Committee accepted that an accelerated procedure be adopted, in particular the shortening of the usual six-month period of study and postal comment by all the Members of the Committee.

The facts that both of those Recommendations were well known, and that all the Member States directly concerned in the work were participating in the working groups concerned, were conducive to the Committee's agreement.

8. LONG-TERM POLICY OF THE ORGANIZATION

Mr BIRKELAND remarked that there was no paper for that item of the agenda, and that the Committee was invited to discuss it orally. Obviously the two subjects, certification and the revision of the working method, were part of the Organization's long-term policy and were even its main elements. However, there were other aspects of long-term policy that the Committee could discuss, and all present were invited to make known their thoughts on the subject.

Mr CHAPPELL reminded the Committee that both it and the Presidential Council had interested itself in the specific character of legal metrology, and how it differed from other activities such as standardization. He drew attention to the general movement across the world of a coming together of the nations, of openness to each other, and of the development of trade. OIML had a role to play in the elimination of barriers to trade by the harmonization of regulations; likewise the problems of safety, health and pollution were subjects of ever closer international collaboration, and there also OIML could play its part. ISO and IEC, for their part, were becoming more active; some of their work might either extend or duplicate that of OIML, and OIML should make its responsibility clearly known. Measuring instruments provided essential infor-

mation for all commercial activity, for health, safety, the control of pollution, etc., and were often used over extended periods of time, during which they were required to continue to work within specified limits of accuracy, repeatability, etc. The international harmonization of those specifications was extremely important and showed clearly OIML's particular future role.

Mr BIRKELAND said that that question had been raised two years earlier by Mr Clapham; the Committee had been invited to submit ideas on the future specific role of OIML. The Presidential Council had received a few contributions on the subject; it had discussed them and had concluded that there were not enough of them, and that more ideas were needed. Mr BIRKELAND therefore invited his colleagues to make their views known either immediately or later by letter.

Mr BIRCH drew attention to the complementary relationship between metrology and quality assurance. Matters touching on quality attracted an enormous amount of attention among governments and administrations in almost every country: it was imperative to increase both competitiveness and productivity simultaneously. To what extent could certain concepts tied to "quality" be replaced by metrological concepts? Should they not be careful to ensure that "good" metrology was not forgotten in the equation that governed that particular situation? The Committee had to state clearly the contribution and utility of legal metrology and must help its members in persuading their governments of that usefulness: the concept of legal metrology was still little understood, and it needed to be "sold". Legal metrology had till then been too much of a national affair: the OIML Certificate System would make it more international. It had to be remarked that the progress made in many fields, especially in matters of quality, had been the result of their internationalization. In the field of legal metrology members would have to internationalize their policies and thoughts if they wanted legal metrology to regain a recognized position. When the Committee had been discussing the revision of the working method it had become evident that there was no consensus of opinion on the distinction between legal metrology and voluntary standardization. The specific character of legal metrology and its complementary relationship with standardization had to be made clear. Currently there was a multiplicity of international forums in which metrology was discussed: OIML would have to be fully aware of all these exterior activities and be in a position to take part in and influence them. The Committee would have sometimes to forget a role that was often a little too technical and take more interest in political matters, or at least in topics that were more general.

Mr BIRKELAND concluded the discussion by reminding his colleagues that they were invited to put their ideas on the what was specific about legal metrology and OIML in writing and send them to the Bureau for discussion by the Presidential Council.

9. DEVELOPING COUNTRIES

The BUREAU read a report on the organization of training courses for developing countries. That action had arisen from a proposal from the OIML Development Council in 1989 that had been accepted by the Committee and according to which the OIML budgetary item for the Development Council in 1990 and 1991 could be used to contribute to the expenses of some (probably four or five) trainees attending courses to be organized by countries volunteering to do so.

The BUREAU had approached a number of countries, and two of them, France and the Federal Republic of Germany, had agreed to consider organizing two training courses on weighing, in French and in English respectively, in June 1991. Up to that

time eight candidates to attend the course in French and twenty-nine candidates for the course in English had been put forward by the Member States and the Corresponding Members. The Bureau was continuing to work with the two host countries and hoped that the projects would go ahead if no budgetary or other forms of restraint intervened.

The BUREAU also made known various other activities undertaken on behalf of developing countries: the publication in the Bulletin of the talks given at the seminar on the planning and construction of metrological laboratories and test houses (September 1989); an enquiry to obtain verification equipment, a contribution to a seminar at UNCTAD and GATT's International Trade Centre, and a search for experts for UNIDO.

Mr REVUELTA FORMOSO indicated that, as a contribution to activities in aid of developing countries, CEN and its Institute of Metrology was organizing in October 1990, for the fifth time, a course in legal metrology, and was awarding ten bursaries; the course was being attended by trainees from Venezuela, Mexico, Costa Rica, Libya, Senegal, Nicaragua, Colombia, and Trinidad and Tobago.

Mr CIBAK informed his colleagues about Czechoslovakia's activities in the field: a new information centre in metrology had been constructed at Bratislava to meet national needs, but which could be used later to house and teach trainees from developing countries, in the framework of OIML's activities.

Mr NOUMSI noted these OIML activities with interest, and suggested that in the future one might envisage taking these training courses to the developing countries themselves; that would allow a greater number of people to be trained simultaneously and in real climatic and environmental conditions.

Mr KOCHSIEK indicated that PTB organized two seminars annually for developing countries; for example in 1990 one on weighing had been organized at Caracas, Venezuela, the other, on standardization and metrology, at Hamburg. In 1991, in addition to the one on weighing there would be another on metrology in the medical field.

10. OIML SEMINARS

The BUREAU mentioned the technical seminars organized to date and gave some details of the latest, "Weighing in Braunschweig", organized in May 1990 with the participation of the Federal Republic of Germany. It proposed that a new seminar be organized in 1992 on a subject to be decided, and asked Committee Members concerned to make their proposals (subject and venue) known.

11. REPORT ON THE ACTIVITIES OF BIML (OCTOBER 1989 TO SEPTEMBER 1990)

The report was distributed to all present.

12. ANY OTHER BUSINESS

There was no other business.

13. DATE AND PLACE OF THE NEXT MEETING

Bearing in mind the General Conference on Weights and Measures, which would be from 30th September to 4th October 1991 and would be attended by some of the Members of CIML, the Committee decided to hold its twenty-sixth meeting from Monday 7th to Wednesday 9th October 1991, in Paris.

DECISIONS AND RESOLUTIONS

Drafts of the decisions proposed to the Committee for its twenty-fifth meeting were read and amended, and the decisions adopted: they are reproduced below.

CLOSURE

ADDRESS BY Mr MARIO VICENTE Vice-President, IPQ

Mr President, Ladies and Gentlemen,

It is apparent that it was an opportune moment when Portugal acceded to the Convention by which OIML was created.

In fact legal metrology in Portugal has made incomparably greater progress since 1984 than in the preceding decades, thanks to the information and Recommendations emanating from OIML.

Thus this twenty-fifth meeting of the International Committee of Legal Metrology represents for us the culmination of our race to establish a national system of metrology.

However, as you were told in the opening session, we have to modernize both the equipment in place and the plant infrastructure.

According to the plan, these operations, including the construction of buildings in six different places, will be completed during the second quarter of 1993.

It is for that reason that I propose straight away that Portugal play host to a meeting of OIML in 1993 so that, if our forecasts prove correct, the new infrastructures may be inaugurated at the same time.

That would be a great honour for us.

I thank each one of you and wish you all a safe return.

*
* *

Mr BIRKELAND expressed, on behalf of all present, his gratitude to the Portuguese authorities for the excellent way in which the meeting had been organized, and for their generous hospitality; he thanked all the delegates for their active participation in the discussion, and all those who had contributed to the success of the meeting. He declared the twenty-fifth meeting of the International Committee of Legal Metrology closed.

DECISIONS TAKEN BY THE COMMITTEE

CIML 1990 – ITEM 1

The Committee approved the minutes of the Twenty-fourth CIML meeting without modification.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 2.1

The Committee took note of an address by Dr KHALED Y. AL KHALAF, CIML Member for Saudi Arabia, a new OIML Member State. The Committee also took note of the fact that there were no new accessions expected at present.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 2.2

The Committee took note of a report by Prof KOCHSIEK, CIML Member for the Federal Republic of Germany, on the reunification of Germany, following which there is only one German Member State of OIML.

The Committee also took note of information given orally about the situation of some Member States that are late in the payment of their contributions to OIML; the Committee considered that there was no need to take measures against them at present.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 3.1

The Committee approved the Auditor's report for 1989 and instructed its President and the Director of the Bureau to submit it to the Ninth Conference.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 3.2

The Committee examined the financial situation of the Organisation for 1990 and took note of information given orally on the foreseeable evolution of expenses in 1991 and on the sharing of the budget amongst Member States following the accession of Saudi Arabia and the reunification of Germany.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 4.1

The Committee elected as Assistant Director, in place of Mr PETIK: Mr VISHENKOV, USSR, from 1st June 1991.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 4.2

The Committee took note of information given orally on the situation of staff members whose contracts end before end 1992.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 5.1

The Committee approved the document "OIML Certificate System for Measuring Instruments" and instructed the Presidential Council and the Bureau to monitor the System's implementation, especially with a view to modifying or improving it according to need; the Committee requested its Members to continue to send to the Bureau their proposals for such improvements; any such amendments shall be submitted to the Committee at future meetings. The Committee also took note of a proposal aimed at facilitating the System's operation through intercomparisons, and instructed the Presidential Council to study that proposal in more detail.

The Committee instructed the Bureau to produce a brochure on the System, to prepare a final draft of the model certificate and to make proposals to the next Conference concerning the certificate registration fee. Initially the fee shall be 200 FRF.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 5.2

The Committee took note of a report on International Recommendations which may be used within the OIML Certificate System and considered it possible for the Issuing Authorities of the Member States to issue voluntarily and from now on certificates with reference to the following International Recommendations:

R 1, 2 and 20 on weights, R 76 on nonautomatic weighing instruments, R 97 on barometers, R 98 on high-precision line measures.

The Committee requested the Bureau and the Secretariats to proceed with the revision of the existing Recommendations to make them applicable to the System and to make sure that all new Recommendations now being drafted will be immediately applicable to the System. The Committee also instructed the Bureau to advise Secretariats on the format of test reports and on how the Committee might approve Recommendations thus revised.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 5.3

The Committee took note of information on actions performed by certain CIML Members to make the OIML Certificate System better known and to promote it at national level; the Committee requested them to provide the Bureau with all this information for distribution to all CIML Members so that similar actions may be performed in all Member States.

The Committee also took note of information on the possibility of developing a computerized data base on OIML certificates; it judged that it would be premature to take any decision about this and requested its Members and the Bureau to reflect on the usefulness of such a database.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 6.1

The Committee examined the following documents:

- an analysis by the Bureau of differences as regards structures and methods for the execution of the technical work between OIML and ISO/IEC,*
- two draft resolutions (CIML 1990 Item 6.1.a and b) presented by the Bureau,*
- a proposal made by the USA on general principles for revising the working methods of OIML Secretariats.*

Concerning the analysis of OIML-ISO/IEC differences, the Members of the Committee expressed their total satisfaction.

The Committee judged unacceptable the point of the draft resolution 6.1.a by which Pilot Secretariats would be abolished and the CIML would be given the role of a technical committee; the Committee also criticised certain provisions of the draft.

The Committee highly appreciated the USA proposal on the general principles to be observed when revising the working method.

To conclude the Committee

- instructed the Bureau to develop draft directives for the OIML technical work on the basis of the discussions during the meeting and of any proposal the Bureau might receive,*
- requested its Members to send urgently to the Bureau any new proposals they considered appropriate,*
- charged the Presidential Council with monitoring the Bureau's work and also with reflecting on the optimal distribution of the global field of the OIML's work between the various working groups which would be created in application of the new directives,*
- charged the Presidential Council with making sure that the new directives and other supplementary proposals will be presented to the Committee not later than its next meeting.*

CIML 1990 – ITEM 6.2

The Committee took note of the enquiry now being conducted on the draft of a Guide entitled "Drafting and presentation of OIML International Recommendations".

CIML 1990 – ITEM 7.1

The Committee took note of the document "State of progress of the work of OIML Secretariats".

CIML 1990 – ITEM 7.2

The Committee considered the situations of some Secretariats and took the following decisions:

- the titles of the Reporting Secretariats within SP 14 "Acoustics and vibration" will be modified according to the Bureau's inquiry,*
- the responsibility for the Reporting Secretariat SP 16-Sr 4 "Dosimetric methods for the industrial use of ionizing radiations" is allocated to the United States of America.*

CIML 1990 – ITEM 7.3

The Committee approved for immediate publication, and then presentation to the Ninth Conference for formal sanction, the following International Recommendations:

- Metrological regulation of load cells*
- High-precision line measures of length*
- Indicating pressure gauges, vacuum gauges and pressure-vacuum gauges*
- Recording pressure gauges, vacuum gauges and pressure-vacuum gauges*
- Instruments for measuring vehicle exhaust emissions*
- Atomic absorption spectrometers for measuring metal pollutants in water.*

Note: The two Recommendations on pressure gauges will be compiled with Recommendation R 94 which was sanctioned by the Eighth Conference, and published as one Recommendation.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 7.4

The Committee accepted an accelerated process for approving revised Recommendations R 74 and R 76, which are expected to be submitted to the Twenty-sixth meeting in 1991.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 8

The Committee took note of proposals made orally in relation to the long-term policy of the Organisation and instructed the Presidential Council to reflect on these matters and to report to the Committee in due time.

The Committee invited its Members to contribute to the discussions about the long-term policy of OIML and to send their observations to the Bureau before the end of 1990 for transmission to the Presidential Council.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 9

The Committee took note of a report on the organisation of training courses for agents of metrology services from developing countries in 1991. The Committee also took note of information given by the Federal Republic of Germany, Cuba and Czechoslovakia on training courses or seminars these countries organize for developing countries, at home or even sometimes in other countries. The Committee then took note of a request by the Delegate from Cameroon for training courses to be organized in the developing countries themselves, so that more persons may be trained simultaneously, at lower cost and in the actual conditions of their future work.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 10

The Committee took note of a report on OIML technical seminars and requested its Members to make proposals to BIML for the organisation of a new seminar in 1992.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 11

The Committee took note of the report of the activities of BIML for the period October 1989 - September 1990.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 12

There was no other business.

CIML 1990 – ITEM 13

The Committee decided that its Twenty-sixth meeting will take place in Paris from 7th to 9th October 1991.

ANNEX 1
RESULTS OF BALLOTS

- A: OIML Certificate System for Measuring Instruments
 B: Metrological regulation of load cells
 C: High-precision line measures of length
 D: Indicating pressure gauges, vacuum gauges and pressure-vacuum gauges
 E: Recording pressure gauges, vacuum gauges and pressure-vacuum gauges
 F: Instruments for measuring vehicle exhaust emissions
 G: Atomic absorption spectrometers for measuring metal pollutants in water

Member States	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
Australia	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Austria	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Belgium	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Bulgaria	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Cameroon	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Canada	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
P.R. of China	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Cuba	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Czechoslovakia	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Denmark	A	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Finland	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
France	A	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	A
German D.R.	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
F.R. of Germany	Y	A	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Greece	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Hungary	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Indonesia	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Ireland	Y	Y	Y	A	A	Y	Y
Italy	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Japan	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	N	N
Kenya	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
R. of Korea	A	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Monaco	A	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Morocco	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Netherlands	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Norway	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Poland	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Portugal	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Romania	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Saudi Arabia	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Spain	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Sweden	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	A	Y
Switzerland	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
United Kingdom	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	N
United States	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
U.S.S.R.	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Yugoslavia	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

Y = yes, A = abstention, N = no

ANNEX 2
DRAFT RESOLUTIONS OFFERED BY THE BUREAU
UNDER ITEM 6.1 OF THE AGENDA
BUT NOT ACCEPTED BY THE COMMITTEE

Revision of the procedure for the drafting of
International Recommendations and Documents

Second Draft Resolution CIML 1990 - Item 6.1.a

The International Committee of Legal Metrology

AWARE of the contents of a report prepared by the BIML and subjected to a preliminary examination by the Presidential Council,

CONSCIOUS of the necessity of improving and accelerating the technical work of the Organization, its planning and its establishing of priorities, of more effective cooperation between Member States in this work, of closer cooperation with sister international institutions in the field of standardization,

CONSCIOUS therefore of the utility of revising the working methods of the Organization and aligning them with those of sister international institutions, wherever it can be accomplished without prejudice to the Organization's aims,

HAVING TAKEN NOTE of the opinions expressed by correspondence or during the meeting by some of its Members,

RESOLVES that the Working Method of OIML Secretariats should be revised and that directives for the technical work of OIML should be developed in line with the common Directives of the IEC and ISO, where appropriate, and on the basis of the following principles:

- (1) the general planning and control of the technical work of OIML and the approval of International Documents and Recommendations shall remain the responsibility of the International Committee of Legal Metrology;
- (2) the existing Pilot Secretariats shall cease to exist and their managing and planning functions shall revert to a Technical Committee, aided by whatever advisory groups it may choose to establish; the International Committee of Legal metrology shall function as the Technical Committee;
- (3) the Technical Committee shall establish, in number that it deems appropriate, Subcommittees with functions similar to those now exercised by Reporting Secretariats, having the same grades of membership, and with the following additional provisions:
 - (a) P-members shall be under an obligation to comment on drafts, to attend meetings whenever possible, and to vote, with the risk of suspension from that grade of membership if they fail to honour those obligations;
 - (b) each Subcommittee shall work under the guidance of a Chairman who shall be independent of the secretariat of the Subcommittee, but who may be a national of the country providing the secretariat;
 - (c) in the absence of an existing international standard to serve as a basis for a draft OIML International Recommendation the production of a first preliminary draft (Subcommittee Draft) shall normally no longer be entirely the work of a single State, but that of a small working group of international membership that is to be disbanded on completion of that task; the members of the working group shall serve only as experts contributing their experience, not as representatives;

- (d) a Subcommittee may establish whatever ad hoc groups it considers desirable to examine any matter relating to a subject the Subcommittee is responsible for;
- (e) the rules of operation of a Subcommittee shall ensure that at every stage in the development of Subcommittee Drafts subsequent to the first the proposals expressed in writing by the due date of every Member shall be communicated in full to every other Member; the manner in which those proposals have been adopted in the subsequent draft, or the reasons why they have not been adopted, shall be clearly indicated, and there shall be full opportunity for the debate of such proposals at meetings of the Subcommittee;
- (f) when a draft is submitted to the Members of the International Committee of Legal Metrology for comments, those comments shall be treated in the same way as those of Members of the Subcommittee, and the draft amended in the light of those comments shall be put to a vote of the Subcommittee;
- (g) the rules for voting in the Subcommittee, the criteria for the approval of a draft, and the quorum to be attained at its meetings shall be such as to ensure that the text that finally emerges enjoys the support of at least a majority of P-members, possibly a substantial majority.

INSTRUCTS the BIML to complete draft directives for the technical work of OIML in accordance with the above principles in sufficient time to be considered by the Presidential Council at its next meeting and to be distributed to the Member States of OIML for adoption by correspondence if possible, or at the next meeting of the Committee.

Draft Resolution CIML 1990 – Item 6.1.b

The International Committee of Legal Metrology

HAVING ADOPTED the Resolution CIML 1990 – Item 6.1.a relating to a revision of the working methods of the Organization,

CONSCIOUS that a superfluity of Subcommittees could hinder the development of the technical work of the Organization,

REQUESTS the Presidential Council, assisted by the BIML, to reflect upon an optimum distribution of the overall technical activity of the Organization between Subcommittees whose number shall be greatly inferior to the number of now existing Reporting Secretariats, and about the opportuneness of establishing some advisory groups,

REQUESTS the Presidential Council to report in time to allow a new programme of work to be adopted during the next meeting of the Committee, if possible.

ANNEX 3
U.S.A. PROPOSAL FOR
GENERAL PRINCIPLES TO BE FOLLOWED
IN THE REVISION OF THE
"WORKING METHOD OF OIML SECRETARIATS"

- 1) To limit the scope of work to the development of International Recommendations and Documents that will promote worldwide harmonization of national laws and regulations pertaining to the performance of measuring instruments used in the exchange of commercial goods and services and in the assurance and promotion of public health and safety and protection of the environment.
- 2) To revise the operating procedures and responsibilities for Pilot and Reporting Secretariats to facilitate the timely and efficient development of OIML Recommendations and Documents.
- 3) To provide specific guidelines for the form, style and content of OIML Recommendations and Documents to improve their timeliness, quality and interpretation.
- 4) To promote and encourage wide participation and complete transparency and openness of the work to ensure its worldwide application through correspondence and meetings including participation of all liaison organizations and relevant responsible national officials, manufacturers, and users of the measuring instruments, which is subject to the work, and whose viewpoints are endorsed by the responsible CIML Member(s).
- 5) To provide specific procedures for the conduct of international and other meetings and for the consideration of official comments provided by CIML Members and by official representatives of liaison organizations.
- 6) To provide open, timely, and fair procedure for an appeal by CIML Members of decisions of Secretariats, the Presidential Council and BIML.

In addition to these general principles, the revision of the "working Method of OIML Secretariats" should take into consideration the relevant IEC/ISO directives on "Organizational structures and their technical work" and "Drafting and presentation of International Standards".

The Bureau is instructed to develop draft directives for the OIML technical work and for the format of OIML Recommendations and Documents following the above mentioned principles, in time for the Presidential Council to examine them at its next meeting before submission of final proposals to the Committee not later than for its next meeting.

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